TOWN OF THUNDERBOLT
SPECIAL CALLED MEETING
TUESDAY, FEBRUARY 2, 2021
6:30 PM

1. **Call to order –** Call meeting order at 6:33 pm

   In attendance: Mayor Beth Goette and Council Members: Dana Williams, Dave Crenshaw, Larry Ward, John Henry, Brooks Barbaree and Ed Drohan. Staff in attendance: Interim Town Administrator, Molly Sims; Town Attorney, Charles Barrow; Clerk of Council, Deatre Denion and Fire Chief, Andrew Bateman. Police Chief, Sean Clayton was virtually in the meeting.

2. **Approval of Meeting Agenda**

   Mayor Goette asked for a motion to approve the agenda. Council Member Ward made the motion with a second by Council Member Crenshaw.

3. **Approval of Devotion, LLC Film Application**

   In attendance for Devotion LLC was Laura Bryant, Location Manager. She thanked Council for holding this special called meeting. Ms. Bryant explained a little about the movie's story that is based on the book Devotion. The scene to be filmed in Thunderbolt is to represent Rhode Island's military base for a clam bake for the pilots. The filming will be on February 12. Ms. Bryant had one of her assistants to canvas the adjacent area to see the residents agreed or did not agree to the afterhours filming. They did not receive any negative responses. They submitted a special request to trim some palm trees and was already granted. Ms. Bryant explained everything will be on private property or school property. Mayor Goette stated Ms. Bryant submitted 15 signatures of agreement but none of the signatures were from River Cove. Ms. Bryant explained they have a separate inconvenience agreement with River Cove. Mayor Goette noticed in the packet there is nothing from TMI giving permission to use their property. Ms. Bryant explained there is an agreement already and will submitted by the next day. Council Member Williams asked about the request to change some of the legal language. Interim Town Administrator Sims stated that request was removed. Interim Town Administrator Sims explained she would like Council to come to an agreement on the filming time and the street closure request. Fire Chief Bateman stated he will let dispatch know of the closure. Interim Town Administrator Sims requested the film company coordinate with the businesses located on the street that is to be intermittently closed concerning their deliveries. Council Member Williams wanted to make sure the police escort the large trucks. Interim Town Administrator Sims stated there were hiccups in the beginning but all trucks since then have been escorted. Council Member Crenshaw asked if fire trucks or ambulances be allowed through. Ms. Bryant explained there is nothing in the street and emergency vehicles

will be allowed through. Council Member Williams asked about large trucks coming in for the one-day filming. Ms. Bryant explained they will be using River or Whatley to bring in equipment. Council Member Ward asked about damages that may occur bringing in the equipment. Town Attorney Barrow explained there is a damage clause in the truck agreement. Council Member Drohan asked about inclement weather, is there a backup date? Ms. Bryant stated there is not a backup date at this time. Council Member Drohan asked if there is any place for people to observe. Ms. Bryant explained with COVID protocols, there is not. Town Attorney Barrow pointed out clarification is needed on the breakdown time. Ms. Bryant explained it takes about 45 minutes to breakdown all the equipment. Anything left from the shoot will be removed the next day. **Council Member Crenshaw made the motion to approve the application and request adding an alternative date for rain out as soon as the film company sets the date. Council Member Williams seconded the motion.** Police Chief Clayton asked Ms. Bryant about reaching out to another agency for security. Ms. Bryant stated she has paperwork with Lt. Thompson and will forward it on to the Police Chief. **The motion passed unanimously.**

4. **Adjourn**

Mayor Goette asked for a motion to adjourn the meeting. **Council Member Ward made the motion with a second by Council Member Williams.** The meeting adjourned 6:56 pm.